



HouseLink
— Z I M B A B W E —

Find Your Next Home with Confidence

THE COMPLETE GUIDE TO
**PROPERTY
DEVELOPMENT**
— AND —
PROPERTY LAW
IN ZIMBABWE

A Practical Guide to Planning, Council Processes,
Building Approvals, Construction, Subdivisions,
Project Management and Professional Practice



4-PAGE SAMPLE PREVIEW

Selected practical extracts from the full 318-page manual.

Before You Buy Land, Investigate What You Are Actually Buying.

The purchase price is only one part of a development decision. Before committing to a site, the developer needs to understand whether the proposed project is practical, permissible and financially realistic.

A Practical Due-Diligence Approach

Before purchasing any development site, investigate not only the property's location and price, but also its planning status, available services, access, title information and any known development restrictions. Early due diligence can prevent expensive surprises later in the project.

This is important because the land you buy may not automatically give you the right to construct whatever development you have in mind. Proposed developments generally need to comply with applicable planning controls, zoning provisions and approval requirements administered by the relevant authority.

PLANNING STATUS

Ask what the property is currently permitted to be used for and whether your intended development is compatible with the applicable planning framework. Do not assume that a well-located property can automatically be used for any purpose you choose.

SERVICES & ACCESS

Consider available services, infrastructure and access as part of the feasibility of the project. These factors can affect both the practicality and the cost of development.

TITLE & RESTRICTIONS

Verify title information and investigate known restrictions before completing the transaction. Legal due diligence can identify issues that may affect the developable area or the proposed use of the property.

Zimbabwe Practical Example

A developer purchases a stand intending to construct a medical centre. Although the property is well located, the land is zoned for residential use. Before construction can proceed, the developer may need the necessary planning approvals, such as a change of land use or special consent, depending on the applicable planning framework and the requirements of the relevant local authority.

THE LESSON

Identifying this issue before construction begins can avoid unnecessary expenditure on unsuitable building plans and reduce the risk of delays.

A Development Is a Process — Not Just a Building Project.

The manual treats property development as a structured process. Each stage builds on the previous one, and skipping or rushing a stage can lead to delays, additional costs or compliance issues.

The Property Development Lifecycle

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS
1. Opportunity Identification	Identify suitable land or redevelopment opportunities.
2. Feasibility Assessment	Evaluate financial, legal, planning and technical viability.
3. Land Acquisition	Purchase or secure development rights over the property.
4. Planning & Design	Prepare layouts, drawings and technical designs.
5. Statutory Approvals	Obtain approvals from relevant authorities where required.
6. Construction	Build in accordance with approved plans and applicable standards.
7. Inspections & Compliance	Meet inspection and compliance requirements during construction.
8. Completion & Handover	Complete final inspections, occupation requirements and project close-out.
9. Management or Sale	Operate, lease, sell or maintain the completed development.

Building Plan Submission Checklist

Before lodging an application, confirm the following:

CHECK
■ Application form completed ■ Property details verified ■ Architectural drawings completed ■ Site plan included ■ Supporting reports attached where applicable ■ Required consultant information included ■ Applicable approvals obtained where required ■ Submission fee confirmed ■ Copies retained for project records

Professional Tip: Maintain organised records, document key decisions, communicate regularly with stakeholders and verify requirements with the relevant authorities at each stage.

The Full Manual Goes Much Further.

These pages are only a small selection of the practical approach used throughout the book. The complete manual is designed to help developers, consultants and property practitioners understand the process before committing time and money.

Inside the 318-page manual

Land & Due Diligence	Planning status, title information, restrictions and early investigation before purchase.
Planning & Approvals	Planning processes, statutory approvals and documentation requirements.
Building & Construction	Building plans, construction compliance, inspections and project coordination.
Professional Practice	Roles of developers, estate agents, town planners, architects, engineers and other consultants.
Property Law	Legal due diligence, property rights and development-related legal considerations.
Project Management	Planning, documentation, budgeting, risk assessment and project records.
Practical Tools	Checklists, registers, examples and structured guidance for applying the concepts.

DON'T START YOUR DEVELOPMENT WITH MISSING INFORMATION.

Get the complete 318-page manual and go beyond this sample with practical guidance on property development, planning, approvals, construction, project management and property law in Zimbabwe.

Digital Copy: \$15 • Printed Copy: \$25

WhatsApp: +263 774 603 913

Note: Requirements can vary between local authorities. Always confirm the current position with the relevant council.